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STUDENT ID NO

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MULTIMEDIA UNIVERSITY

FINAL EXAMINATION

TRIMESTER OCTOBER/ NOVEMBER 2025 (TERM 2530)

LAE 1113 – ACADEMIC ENGLISH
(All Sections)

25 FEBRUARY 2026
9.00 a.m. – 11.00 a.m.
(2 Hours)

INSTRUCTIONS TO STUDENT

1. This question paper consists of **SIXTEEN** pages with 2 sections only.
2. Answer **ALL** questions.
3. Please write all your answers in the question paper.
4. This question paper is **NOT** allowed to be taken out of the examination hall.

STUDENT ID	:	
COURSE	:	
LECTURER	:	
GROUP (IF APPLICABLE)	:	
VENUE	:	

QUESTION	MARKS
TOTAL	

EXAMINER AUTHORIZATION: Tick (✓) in the appropriate box.

All written pages have been checked.

All marks have been calculated correctly.

Examiner 1:

Signature and Date:

Examiner 2:

Signature and Date:

SECTION A: READING AND VOCABULARY [30 MARKS]**Part 1 (15 Marks)**

Instructions: Read the passage and answer the following questions.

The Enduring Nostalgia of American Girl Dolls

- 1 Since 1986, American Girl dolls have captivated young audiences by 1
deeply engaging their imagination and offering something fundamentally
different from typical toys. Created by educator Pleasant Rowland, these
historically focused dolls have taught generations of children about
American history while inspiring them to recognise their own potential. 5
- 2 Sydney Rose Paulsen, now a doll photographer with nearly 60,000
Instagram followers, remembers how the American Girl books shaped her
worldview as a homeschooled child. “They were my context for how people
who didn’t have my background or grew up in my time lived,” she recalls.
Through characters like pioneer Kirsten Larson, Virginia colonist Felicity 10
Merriman, and Addy Walker, who escaped enslavement during the Civil
War, where Addy was treated as property and forced to work without
freedom, Paulsen developed a sophisticated understanding of historical
connection. She learned why Kittredge wore simpler dresses during the
Great Depression while 1950s character Maryellen Larkin could afford 15
poodle skirts as each reflecting their era’s economic realities.
- 3 What distinguished American Girl from competitors was its
commitment to historical accuracy and educational value. The company
hired historians and researchers to ensure products authentically represented
their time periods. Each doll, priced between \$65 and \$110, came with 20
meticulously researched accessories, from 1940s radios to 1820s adobe
ovens, which are traditional clay ovens made from sun-dried mud, as well as
a six-book series chronicling their lives. Initially available only through
mail-order catalogues, the brand expanded to retail stores starting with
Chicago in 1998. 25
- 4 The company’s debut coincided with a cultural shift in the 1990s. “It
was really a moment with that early sense of girls can do history too,”
explains public historian Dominique Jean-Louis. By focusing on individual
stories rather than dates and facts, American Girl created an ‘entry point’ for
children to engage with history personally. The characters confronted real 30
historical challenges head-on. Samantha Parkington spoke out against child
labour after her friend faced brutal factory work. Julie Albright fought for
her right to play on the boys’ basketball team using Title IX. “The dolls
paired stories of oppression with narratives of kindness and community and
survival,” as scholar Emilie Zaslow notes, inspiring girls to envision – to 35
picture in their minds – their own potential for social change.
- 5 Addy Walker, the first character of colour introduced in 1993, sparked
both praise and controversy. Developed over three years with an advisory
board including Lonnie Bunch, now secretary of the Smithsonian Institution,
Addy’s story didn’t shy from slavery’s brutality. In one memorable scene, 40
she was forced to eat worms as punishment. “It’s a vivid and striking
moment that helped make broad concepts into really personal and immediate

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stories,” according to Jean-Louis. Critics questioned whether focusing on enslavement perpetuated stereotypes, but the advisory board felt strongly about showing the struggle and survival of African Americans as a major human accomplishment. 45

- 6 Kaya, a Nez Perce character released in 2002, represented another ambitious effort. After five years of development and extensive consultation with the Nez Perce community, American Girl even created a new face mold depicting Kaya with her mouth closed, respecting the tribe’s view of bared teeth as aggressive. By setting her story in the 1760s, before European colonisation, the advisory board ensured children could visualise the Nez Perce people at the height of their culture. 50

- 7 Yet the brand has faced ongoing criticism. Its historical line has remained predominantly white, and recent dolls have emphasised traditionally feminine spheres over earlier characters’ broader historical engagement. Of the Black historical characters, only Addy and civil rights-era Melody Ellison remain available, and both centred on racial struggle rather than celebration. This highlights the line’s limited and narrow racial representation. The dolls’ high cost has also made the American Girl experience financially inaccessible to many families. 60

- 8 When American Girl recently revived its six original historical characters, nostalgic adult fans responded with overwhelming enthusiasm. This reaction shows the brand’s lasting cultural impact. During World War II, many innocent families were relocated and confined to government-controlled compounds, where they were unable to move freely or live normal lives. This has inspired fans to imagine new stories from different perspectives. Now, fans propose new characters: a Japanese American girl in the war’s detention camps, a Harlem Renaissance story focused on joy rather than struggle, or a girl experiencing the late 19th-century Exoduster Movement. 65

- 9 As Paulsen reflects, the brand’s enduring message is that girls are the same throughout history even though culture changes. American Girl has succeeded, she concludes, in demonstrating that “girls are capable of so much, and they have been forever.” 75

Adapted from Meilan, S. (2021, June 3). The enduring nostalgia of American dolls. Smithsonian Magazine. <https://www.smithsonianmag.com/history/evolution-american-girl-dolls-180977822/>

Question I: Contextual Clues (5 Marks)

Instructions: Find a word in each given paragraph for the meanings below.

- a. attracted and held someone’s attention (Paragraph 1)

- b. systematic condition in which individuals are legally or socially deprived of personal freedom, autonomy and basic human rights (Paragraph 2)

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- c. to imagine future possibilities or outcomes with intention and clarity (Paragraph 4)
- d. very clear, detailed and intense in a way that makes something feel real or easy to imagine (Paragraph 5)
- e. the state of being held, confined or imprisoned during a time of war (Paragraph 8)

Question II: Facts vs. Opinions (5 Marks)

Instructions: For each statement, write (F) if the statement is fact and (O) if the statement is an opinion.

- a. Sydney Rose Paulsen, now a doll photographer with nearly 60,000 Instagram followers, remembers how the American Girl books shaped her worldview as a homeschooled child.
- b. "The dolls paired stories of oppression with narratives of kindness and community and survival," as scholar Emilie Zaslow notes, inspiring girls to envision their own potential for social change.
- c. Critics questioned whether focusing on enslavement perpetuated stereotypes, but the advisory board felt strongly about showing the struggle and survival of African Americans as a major human accomplishment.
- d. Of the Black historical characters, only Addy and civil rights-era Melody Ellison remain available, and both centred on racial struggle rather than celebration.
- e. As Paulsen reflects, the brand's enduring message is that girls are the same throughout history even though culture changes.

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Question III: Comprehension (5 Marks)

Instructions: Answer the following questions in complete sentences.

- a. How did reading American Girl books influence Sydney Rose Paulsen's understanding of the past? (1 mark)

- b. How was American Girl different from its competitors? (1 mark)

- c. According to paragraph four, how did American Girl create a way for children to engage with history? (1 mark)

- d. What ongoing criticisms have been directed at the American Girl brand? (1 mark)

Continued...

- e. What does the enthusiastic response from adult fans reveal about the American Girl brand? (1 mark)

Continued...

Part 2 (15 Marks)

Instructions: Read the passage and answer the following questions.

Selling Feelings: The Psychology Behind Emotional Branding

- 1 Most consumers believe their choices are guided by logic and practicality, but marketing psychology tells a different story. Research by Gerald Zaltman of Harvard Business School found that 95 percent of purchasing decisions are driven by subconscious emotion rather than rational thought. Whether buying a coffee, smartphone, or car, people often justify their choices with logic only after emotions have already shaped the decision. This emotional pull forms the foundation of what marketers call *emotional branding*—the practice of building connections that make people feel rather than merely think. 1 5
- 2 Leading global brands have long realised that customers buy stories and feelings, not just products. Coca-Cola’s “Open Happiness”, Apple’s “Think Different”, and Nike’s “Just Do It” are not campaigns about features or prices; they are about joy, creativity, and empowerment. When Nike released its campaign featuring athlete Colin Kaepernick, sales rose by 31 percent within three days, showing that emotional storytelling even when controversial can strengthen loyalty by appealing to shared values. Consumer psychologist Paco Underhill summarises this effect neatly: “People don’t buy shoes. They buy motivation, identity, and belonging.” 10 15
- 3 Scientific evidence supports this view. A 2022 Nielsen study revealed that advertisements with emotional content generated 23 percent higher sales impact than those with purely rational appeals. Neuromarketing research using functional Magnetic Resonance Imaging (fMRI) scans shows that emotional messages activate the amygdala and limbic system, the brain’s emotional centre while logical messages trigger areas linked to short-term reasoning. This explains why heart-warming advertisements such as Dove’s “Real Beauty” series are remembered long after the details of their product lines are forgotten. 20 25
- 4 While happiness and positivity often dominate advertising, emotional branding extends far beyond cheerful imagery. Marketers recognise that a variety of emotions can be strategically employed to influence behaviour in subtle ways. Fear, nostalgia, pride, and even guilt have become powerful psychological triggers that shape how consumers respond to messages. Public-health campaigns, for instance, rely on fear to promote safety and discourage risky behaviour, whereas luxury brands like Rolex evoke pride and aspiration to justify exclusivity and social prestige. Meanwhile, nostalgia marketing, popularised by brands such as Pokémon and Disney, draws on collective childhood memories to evoke comfort and belonging. These examples show that emotional branding operates across multiple emotions to build deep and lasting connections with consumers. 30 35
- 5 Social belonging is another central pillar of emotional branding. In a world where identity is increasingly performed online, people express who they are through what they buy. Sharing a Starbucks photo on Instagram or wearing Lululemon activewear is not just consumption, it is communication. A 2023 Deloitte survey found that 64 percent of Gen Z 40

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- consumers purchase brands that reflect their personal values, particularly sustainability, inclusion, and social justice. Psychologist Jennifer Aaker describes this phenomenon as “brand self-extension,” where products become symbols of personal identity. 45
- 6 However, the psychological strength of emotional branding raises ethical questions. Critics argue that it can manipulate vulnerabilities and promote impulsive consumption. The American Psychological Association (APA) notes that emotional advertising may contribute to unhealthy self-image and materialistic behaviour, particularly among young audiences. 50 For instance, beauty campaigns that exploit insecurity to sell skincare or diet products blur the line between persuasion and psychological manipulation. Sociologist Zygmunt Bauman warned that such “liquid consumption” keeps people in a constant cycle of desire and dissatisfaction, buying relief that never lasts. 55
- 7 This influence also carries significant economic implications. Emotional attachment can drive customers to remain loyal even when superior alternatives are available. According to Gallup, a well-known global research organisation that studies human behaviour and consumer engagement, fully engaged consumers who feel emotionally connected to a brand generate 23 percent higher profitability compared to average customers. However, such loyalty can sometimes become irrational, as fans 65 defend their preferred companies much like they would a favourite sports team. The enduring devotion surrounding Apple’s ecosystem, for instance, often persists despite higher prices or limited compatibility. These examples illustrate that emotional attachment can foster strong, even irrational loyalty that benefits companies economically and transforms 70 purchasing into a shared cultural experience.
- 8 The digital landscape has intensified these dynamics. Social media algorithms now track engagement and sentiment, allowing advertisements to appear when users are most emotionally receptive, such as late at night, after breakups, or during stressful events. A 2024 European Commission 75 report on affective computing warns that such emotional targeting could exploit psychological states without consent. Policymakers are considering stricter regulations to protect users from hyper-personalised marketing that reads emotions through facial recognition or tone analysis.
- 9 Ultimately, emotional branding reminds us that shopping is no longer 80 a simple exchange of money for goods; it is a psychological experience shaped by storytelling, identity, and social connection. Yet this power also demands responsibility. The challenge for marketers is to use emotional appeal responsibly and ethically, while the challenge for consumers is to recognise when feelings, rather than facts, are guiding their choices. As the saying goes, “People forget what you said or did but never how you made 85 them feel.” In today’s marketplace, that truth sells better than any slogan, but it also calls for awareness and integrity on both sides.

Adapted from Klein, L. (2024, March 2). Selling Feelings: The Psychology Behind Emotional Branding. Harvard Business Review. <https://hbr.org/2024/03/selling-feelings-the-psychology-behind-emotional-branding>

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Comprehension (15 marks)

Instructions: Answer the following questions in complete sentences.

- a. What can be inferred from the sentence “95 percent of purchasing decisions are driven by subconscious emotion rather than rational thought” (lines 3-5) (2 marks)

- b. According to paragraph two, how do the slogans of companies like Coca-Cola, Apple, and Nike differ from traditional advertising campaigns? (2 marks)

- c. What does the 2022 Nielsen study show, and how does the passage explain why emotional advertisements are remembered longer than rational ones? (2 marks)

Continued...

- d. According to paragraph seven, how can emotional attachment influence customer loyalty? Explain your answer and support it with an example from the passage. (3 marks)

- e. What is the author's overall purpose in writing the article "*Selling Feelings: The Psychology Behind Emotional Branding*"? (1 mark)

- f. Identify the intended audience for this article. Support your answer with **ONE** piece of evidence from the text. (2 marks)

Continued...

- g. Identify the author's tone in paragraph nine. Justify your answer with evidence from the paragraph. (2 marks)

- h. What is the author's point of view on emotional branding? (1 mark)

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SECTION B: GRAMMAR [20 MARKS]**Question I: Modal Verbs (10 Marks)**

Instructions: Fill in the blanks with a suitable modal verb. Write your answer in the table provided.

Can Technology Ever Replace Real Human Bodies?

With a few commands, you (0) can shrink a human chest down to a speck. Then, you return it to life-size and strip away the layers. This futuristic experience is becoming common as instructors (1) _____ adopt virtual reality and digital tools to teach anatomy. In some classrooms, where students (2) _____ gather around cadavers or human corpses, digital reconstructions now allow them to explore anatomy and locate specific features. It is conceivable that, with interactive diagrams, artificial intelligence (AI) assistants and virtual reality, new technology (3) _____ provide an effective alternative when real bodies are not used. However, digital tools may miss lessons only real dissection can teach.

Despite this, many institutions are increasingly adopting digital cadaver technology to complement traditional methods. Digital cadaver tables are now popular, and using them, students (4) _____ study cadaver scans in detail and explore anatomical structures interactively. These tools are so advanced that some schools have removed real cadavers entirely. Experts say students (5) _____ have easily incorporated their digital skills into learning, since they (6) _____ rotate and manipulate digital cadavers in ways impossible with real bodies. If they make a mistake, they (7) _____ reset the model instantly. AI assistants included with the new tables (8) _____ listen and respond to voice commands, as these tasks are part of their roles in assisting students and educators. In addition, they (9) _____ record each interaction to help instructors monitor students' progress.

In the future, anatomy classrooms are expected to rely more on digital and synthetic bodies than real human cadavers. At the same time, medical students are often reminded that cadavers and digital models represent valuable learning resources. Thus, they (10) _____ treat digital and real cadaver materials with respect, as these represent the generosity of donors.

Adapted from: Jampel, S. (2025, November 21). *Medical students are learning anatomy from digital cadavers: Can technology ever replace real human bodies?* Smithsonian.
<https://www.smithsonianmag.com/science-nature/medical-students-are-learning-anatomy-from-digital-cadavers-can-technology-ever-replace-real-human-bodies-180987731/>

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Answers:

- | | | | | |
|-----|------------|----------|------------|------------|
| 0. | A can | B must | C shall | D should |
| 1. | A will | B must | C should | D might |
| 2. | A would | B might | C may | D should |
| 3. | A must | B may | C should | D ought to |
| 4. | A would | B can | C must | D might |
| 5. | A could | B should | C must | D might |
| 6. | A ought to | B could | C must | D might |
| 7. | A shall | B might | C will | D would |
| 8. | A may | B might | C could | D should |
| 9. | A may | B will | C might | D shall |
| 10. | A will | B would | C ought to | D can |

A

Continued...

Question II: Faulty Modifiers (10 Marks)

Instructions: For Questions 1-5, choose the BEST answer from options A, B, C, and D that is **free** of Faulty Modifiers. Circle the correct answer.

1. A. Along with diet, maintaining a healthy weight and preventing obesity is helped by exercise.
 B. Along with diet, exercise plays an important role in maintaining a healthy weight and preventing obesity.
 C. Along with maintaining a healthy weight, diet and exercise prevent obesity.
 D. Along with obesity prevention, exercise and diet help maintain a healthy weight.

2. A. For good health, studies show that adults should get seven to eight hours of sleep a night.
 B. Studies show that adults should get seven to eight hours of sleep a night for maintaining good health.
 C. Studies show that for good health, adults should get seven to eight hours of sleep a night.
 D. For good health, seven to eight hours of sleep a night should be gotten by adults, studies show.

3. A. Online gaming, which is proven to be exceptional at uplifting our mood and repelling dullness, takes us to a new world where our mind forgets stress.
 B. Online gaming takes us to a new world, which is proven to be exceptional at uplifting our mood and repelling dullness, where our mind forgets stress.
 C. Online gaming takes us to a new world, where our mind forgets stress, which is proven to be exceptional at uplifting our mood and repelling dullness.
 D. Online gaming takes us to a new world where our mind, which is proven to be exceptional at uplifting our mood and repelling dullness, forgets stress.

4. A. Procrastinators are often perfectionists, for whom it may be psychologically more acceptable to never tackle a job than to face the possibility of not doing it well.
 B. Procrastinators may find it more acceptable psychologically to never tackle a job than to risk not doing it well are regarded as being perfectionist.
 C. Psychologically more acceptable to never tackle a job than to risk not doing it well, procrastinators are often perfectionists.

Continued...

- D. Concerned about what others think, putting their futures at risk to avoid judgment may be a habit of procrastinators.
5. A. Simmering the sauce, the kitchen smell delicious.
B. The chef made the kitchen smell delicious, simmering the sauce.
C. Simmering the sauce, the smell filled the kitchen.
D. Simmering the sauce, the chef made the kitchen smell delicious.

Instructions: For Questions 6-10, read the paragraph given and identify the sentence that contains a faulty modifier. Write the letter of that sentence and correct it in the space provided.

Example:

0. (A) Learning how to programme and code is only one element of the field. (B) Computer scientists design, develop, and analyse the software and hardware used to solve problems in all kinds of business, industry, scientific, and social contexts. (C) Because computers solve problems to serve and enrich people, there is a significant human component to computer science. (D) Depending on both technical knowledge and essential skills like communication, problem solving, critical thinking, and creativity, the range and complexity of the projects they take on are managed by computer scientists.

Error: Sentence D

Correction: Depending on both technical knowledge and essential skills like communication, problem solving, critical thinking, and creativity, computer scientists manage the range and complexity of the projects they take on.

6. (A) In past years, a study found a strong link between chocolate consumption and lower risk of heart and circulatory diseases. (B) Linked to the biggest reduction in risk, it suggested 45g of chocolate per week was beneficial. (C) Eating more chocolate than this was potentially related to bad health effects from eating too much sugar. (D) The study did not record chocolate type with high flavanol content, so it cannot prove that dark chocolate reduces heart disease risk. (1 mark)

Error:

Correction:

Continued...

7. (A) Connecting people across the globe, social media allows users to maintain friendships despite physical distance. (B) With its real-time updates, social media keeps individuals informed about the latest news and trends. (C) Platforms like Facebook, TikTok and Instagram, known for fostering online communities, give users a sense of belonging. (D) Furthermore, by encouraging creative expression and using algorithms, talents are shared by people with the help of social media. (1 mark)

Error:

Correction:

8. (A) Drifting apart due to constant arguments, couples in toxic relationships struggle to maintain trust. (B) With lingering resentment, each partner finds it difficult to communicate honestly about their feelings. (C) The relationship causes emotional strain, marked by jealousy and control, that affects both individuals. (D) Feeling emotionally drained, they often avoid confrontation, hoping the problems will resolve on their own. (1 mark)

Error:

Correction:

Continued...

9. (A) Calming rhythms and familiar melodies, which allow them to remain comfortable and relaxed throughout the procedure, are provided in surgery for patients to listen to. (B) Comforted by calming music, brain scans are conducted while patients remain still. (C) Many operating rooms now incorporate sound into their surgical routines. (D) Besides aiding patients, the integration of sound helps the surgical team coordinate effectively and respond rapidly to any changes during the procedure. (1 mark)

Error:

Correction:

10. (A) The term “burnout” was coined in the 1970s by the American psychologist Herbert Freudenberger. (B) He used it to describe the consequences of severe stress and high ideals in caregiving professions. (C) Exhausted, listless, and overwhelmed, burnout often affects doctors and nurses who sacrifice themselves for others. (D) Nowadays, this term is not only used for caregiving professions or the dark side of self-sacrifice, but it can also refer to anyone from stressed-out career-driven individuals and celebrities to overworked employees and homemakers. (1 mark)

Error:

Correction:

End of Paper

